

Accountant / Bursar Manual

Finance workflows: fees, charges, payments and statements

School Management Platform

Accountant / Bursar Manual

A finance-focused guide for the **Bursar** role. You have full operational control over fees and payments, plus read-only access to student/guardian/ staff records (so you can find who you're billing) — you have **no** access to academic data (results, attendance, assessments, CBT) at all.

Login

Go to the sign-in page, enter your **Email address** and **Password**, click **Sign in**. Use **Forgot password?** if needed.

Dashboard

After signing in you land on the **Dashboard**. It shows a school-wide snapshot, including a **Fees** KPI card (total outstanding / collected) if the Reporting module is on. Your actual working area is **Fees**, in the left navigation.

Fee categories

Purpose: The named types of charge your school uses (Tuition, Books, PTA levy, etc.) — set up once, reused everywhere. **Who can do this:** School Admin and Bursar.

Steps: Go to **Fees** → **Categories**. Add a category with a name. That's it — categories have no amount of their own; the amount comes from a **Fee structure**.

Fee structures

Purpose: Define how much a category costs for a given session/term/ level/(arm). **Who can do this:** School Admin and Bursar.

Steps: 1. Go to **Fees** → **Fee structures** → **Create**. 2. Choose the category, session, optional term, level, and optional arm. 3. Enter the amount. 4. Save.

Important: Editing a structure later never changes charges already raised from it — each raised charge is a permanent snapshot of the amount at the time it was charged. Create a new structure (or edit this one) for future terms only.

Student charges

Purpose: Actually bill a student — creates a charge on their statement. **Who can do this:** School Admin and Bursar.

Steps: 1. Go to **Fees**, search for the student, open their statement. 2. Under **Charges**, there's a way to raise a new charge for that student (from a structure, or a one-off manual amount + description). 3. Save — it appears immediately on their statement as **Outstanding**.

Discounts / waivers

Purpose: Reduce or forgive part or all of a specific charge. **Who can do this:** School Admin and Bursar.

Steps — apply a discount: 1. On the student's statement, find the charge. 2. Click **Discount**, enter an amount and optional reason, click **Apply**. This reduces the payable amount — the charge is not removed, just reduced.

Steps — waive a charge outright: 1. Click **Waive** next to the charge, confirm. 2. This forgives the *remaining* balance completely. It's reversible — click **Reverse waiver** if it was applied in error; the balance becomes payable again.

Common mistakes: A discount can't exceed what's still owed on that charge — the form will reject an over-large discount.

Recording payments

Purpose: Log money actually received (cash, bank transfer, POS, cheque, or other — not online/Paystack, which records itself automatically). **Who can do this:** School Admin and Bursar.

Steps: 1. Open the student's statement → **Record payment**. 2. Enter **Amount received**, **Payment date**, a **Reference / receipt number** (must be unique per school — duplicates are rejected), and the **Method**. 3. Optionally fill in payer name/phone/email and notes. 4. If there are outstanding charges, you can **allocate** the payment to one or more of them right away (enter how much goes to each) — or leave it unallocated as a credit you can allocate later. 5. Click **Record payment**.

Expected result: The payment appears on the statement; any allocated amount reduces the matching charge's outstanding balance immediately.

Common mistakes: - Reference numbers must be unique — reusing one from a previous receipt is rejected. - You can't allocate more to a charge than it actually still owes, or more in total than the payment itself.

Payment allocation

Covered above — allocation happens at the moment you record a payment, or you can leave a payment unallocated and come back to allocate it against a charge later from the same statement screen.

Outstanding balances

Purpose: See who owes what, right now. **Steps:** 1. Go to **Fees** — shows school-wide totals (charged/discounted/ collected) and a searchable list of every student with their current outstanding balance. 2. Search by name or admission number. 3. For a full breakdown per class/level, use **Reports** → **Fees** (see below) with filters.

Statements

Purpose: A single student's complete financial picture. **Steps:** Open the student from the **Fees** list (or search). You'll see five summary figures (Charged, Discounted, Waived, Paid, Outstanding), the full list of **Charges** (with status badges: Outstanding / Paid / Waived), and the full list of **Payments** (with allocation detail).

Payment history

The **Payments** panel on a student's statement is the full history — every payment ever recorded for that student, including voided ones (shown with a **Voided** badge and the void reason).

Voiding a payment: click **Void** next to a payment, confirm. This reverses it from balance calculations but **keeps the record** — nothing is ever deleted. This cannot be undone from the UI; a genuine reversal needs a new corrective entry if money needs to move again.

Online payment visibility

If your school has Paystack configured (School Admin sets this up under **School settings** → **Payments**), parents/students see a **Pay online** button on their own statement. A successful online payment is verified by the system itself and appears automatically as a payment on the student's statement, tagged with the **Paystack** method — you don't need to do anything manually, but you can see it in the payment history like any other payment. You never see or handle the Paystack secret key — that's configuration-only, entered once by School Admin.

Financial reports

Purpose: Filtered, exportable views across the whole school's fee activity. **Steps:** 1. Go to **Reports** → **Fees & collections**. 2. Tabs: **Collection summary**, **Outstanding balances** (filterable by session/period/level/arm), **Payment activity** (filterable by method/ date range — includes Paystack payments). 3. **Export CSV** for any of these, respecting your current filters.

Relevant audit information

You do **not** hold audit-log access ([audit.view](#)) unless your School Admin has also granted you the Principal role elsewhere — as Bursar alone, you won't see the **Audit Log** link. Every payment you record, void, or adjust is still tracked internally by the system for the administrators who do have that access.

What you can do vs. what's reserved for others

Action	You (Bursar)
View students/guardians/staff	✓ (read-only, for billing)
Record/void payments, discount/waive charges	✓
Configure fee categories/structures	✓
View/export fee reports	✓
View/edit any academic data (results, attendance, assessments, CBT)	✗ — no access at all
Manage school settings, modules, or members	✗ — School Admin only
View the Audit Log	✗ — School Admin/Principal only
